CHAPTER 03

Read the road before acting

Reading a road means combining instructions, movement, visibility and uncertainty. A sign tells you something important; it rarely tells you everything needed for the next decision.

In this chapter

M03-L01 · Recognise what a sign asks

M03-L02 · Combine the instructions

M03-L03 · Find your way without rushing

M03-L04 · Leave room to respond

M03-R · Review and self-assessment

Answers and review guidance

Official references

This material is a learning aid to help you understand Swedish driving theory. It is not an official source and cannot replace official information from Trafikverket and Transportstyrelsen. Always consult their current guidance and the applicable rules.

M03-L01

Recognise what a sign asks

Your goal: Classify the main sign families and describe the decision each one prompts.

Start with purpose, then read the specific symbol and any supplementary panel. The official catalogue groups signs by function. Do not rely on colour alone: similar shapes can communicate different duties, and some important signs have distinctive shapes.
Transportstyrelsen: sign catalogue

Five sign families

Separate examples, not a roadside assembly. Read each caption as well as the shape and colour.

A15 · Children ahead

Varning för barn

Children often cross or remain near this stretch. The sign supplies a warning, not a numerical speed limit. Two children inside a warning triangle.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

B1 · Give way

Väjningsplikt

Yield to vehicles on the crossing road or route. With a distance or stop-ahead panel, this can instead be advance information. Inverted triangular give-way sign.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

C31 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 30: maximum 30 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

D1 · Mandatory direction

Påbjuden körriktning

Travel only in a direction shown by the arrow or arrows. Arrow points left.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

E5 · Built-up area

Tättbebyggt område

A built-up area begins. Establish the applicable speed limit and other rules; a separate sign may prescribe a different limit. Black settlement skyline on white.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

Family	What to establish	A useful driving question
A — warning	The nature of a hazard ahead	What might be hidden, and how much space do I need?
B — priority	A duty or relationship at a conflict point	Must I yield or stop, and to whom?
C — prohibition/restriction	What movement, vehicle or limit is restricted	Does this apply to my vehicle and journey?
D — mandatory instruction	The required route, side or permitted traffic	Which path must I take?
E — instruction	A road or area with a particular meaning or regime	Which rules begin or end here?

These are learning questions, not substitutes for the individual sign descriptions. A warning of children, for example, does not assign a new numerical speed by itself; your speed must still allow safe control and a response to foreseeable hazards. A posted maximum speed is a ceiling, not a demand to maintain that speed. Road Signs Regulation, chapter 2 · Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§14–15

Requirements. B1 means yield to vehicles on the crossing road or route. Make that intention clear early and proceed only without danger or obstruction. B2 requires a stop before entering the crossing road or track area. Stop at the stop line; without one, stop immediately before the signal or before entering the crossing road or track area, as applicable. A rolling pause does not meet a stop duty. Road Signs Regulation, B1–B2 · Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§5 and 19

Yield and stop

Signs and markings are labelled teaching counterparts. These examples do not establish their position in a particular road scene.

B1 · Give way

Väjningsplikt

Yield to vehicles on the crossing road or route. With a distance or stop-ahead panel, this can instead be advance information. Inverted triangular give-way sign.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

B2 · Stop

Stopplikt

Make a complete stop before entering the crossing road, route or track area. Use the stop line; without one, apply the prescribed stopping position. Red octagon bearing STOP.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

M13 · Stop line

Stopplinje

This identifies where to stop when a sign or signal requires it. The line alone does not create a universal stop duty. Wide transverse white stop line.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

M14 · Give-way line

Väjningslinje

This identifies the line drivers should not pass while yielding. Row of white give-way triangles.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

M18 · Give way or stop ahead marking

Förberedande upplysning om väjningsplikt eller stopplikt

Prepare for a yielding or stopping duty further ahead in your direction. White inverted triangle painted on the road.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Apply the learning

A narrow rural bridge with an oncoming van. The scene shows the approach; the separate official examples explain warnings and priority. Not to scale.

Worked decision. You see a warning sign for a narrow section. You reduce speed and look for oncoming traffic before reaching it. You then read any priority instruction at the narrow point. The warning alone did not decide who should pass first.

Narrow roads: warning and priority

Compare the three narrowing shapes. B6 and B7 show opposing viewpoints, never simultaneous instructions to one approach.

A5 · Road narrows

Varning för avsmalnande väg

Expect less road width ahead. The warning does not by itself decide priority over oncoming traffic. The road narrows on both sides.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

A5-2 · Road narrows

Varning för avsmalnande väg A5-2

Expect less road width ahead. The warning does not by itself decide priority over oncoming traffic. The road narrows from the right.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

A5-3 · Road narrows

Varning för avsmalnande väg A5-3

Expect less road width ahead. The warning does not by itself decide priority over oncoming traffic. The road narrows from the left.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

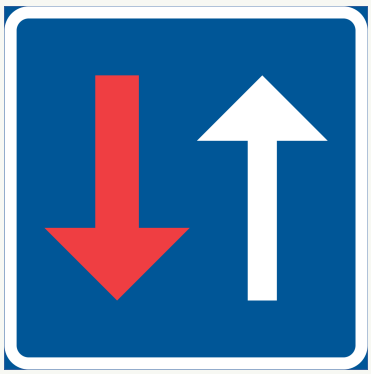
Continue the learning

B6 · Give way to oncoming traffic

Väjningsplikt mot mötande trafik

Yield to oncoming vehicles at the restricted section. Upward red arrow beside a downward black arrow.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



B7 · Oncoming traffic must give way

Mötande trafik har väjningsplikt

Oncoming vehicles have the yielding duty. Do not force passage when it would be unsafe. Upward white arrow beside a downward red arrow on blue.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Knowledge check. Does seeing a warning sign tell you an exact safe speed?

Remember: Identify the instruction and turn it into an early action. The illustrated sign reference is prepared separately from this text.

M03-L02

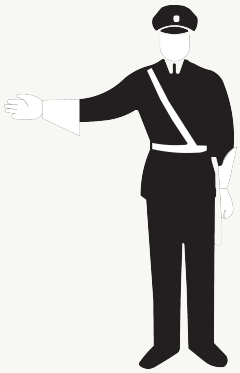
Combine the instructions

Your goal: Interpret signs, panels, markings and signals together, including authorised directions.

Requirements. Follow the traffic instructions that apply to you. Where an instruction differs from a general traffic rule, the instruction governs. A steady traffic-light indication takes precedence over a yield or stop sign; a police officer's direction takes precedence over the rules and ordinary traffic instructions. This is not a rule that a green signal cancels every other restriction. Authorised guards also give traffic directions that must be followed. Traffic Regulation, chapter 2 §§2–4

Authorised directions

Separate examples. A static picture does not show the complete movement; read the description and the official instruction.



P1 · Police stop instruction — front and rear

Stopp

Traffic approaching the officer from the front or rear must stop; traffic approaching from the sides may proceed. The officer's continuing orientation matters even after the arm movement. Officer faces the viewer with one arm extended sideways.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

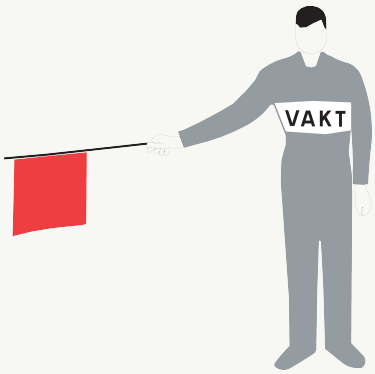
Continue the learning

P2 · Police stop instruction — palm facing you

Stopp

Stop if the officer's palm faces you. A stop paddle may be used instead. Officer raises a palm towards approaching traffic.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



V1 · Traffic guard — stop

Stopp

Stop if the guard faces you. A red lamp is used in darkness; an authorised stop sign marked Vakt may also be used. Guard faces approaching traffic and holds a red flag sideways.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

V3 · Traffic guard identifier

Kännetecken

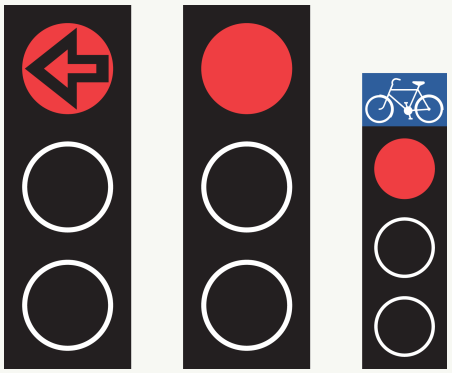
The guard identifier must be worn on the front and back. It identifies the role rather than giving a separate movement instruction. Garment identification panel bearing VAKT.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

For ordinary vehicle signals: red means stop; red and amber together still mean stop, with green approaching. Green permits movement, subject to other duties and space ahead. Amber means stop unless, when green changes to amber, you are already so close that stopping would be dangerous. Flashing amber requires particular caution; read the signs and applicable rules. Arrow signals apply to the direction indicated. Road Signs Regulation, chapter 3 §§3–6

Ordinary vehicle signals

Red, red/amber, green and amber appear in that order. Flashing amber is a separate condition, not the next stage of the normal cycle. Arrow indications apply to the direction shown.

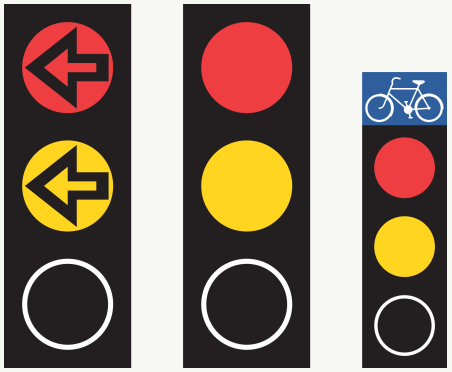


SIG1 · Red vehicle signal

Röd

Stop before the stop line or, if none, before the signal. An outline arrow limits the indication to the direction shown. Red left arrow, red full lamp and red bicycle signal examples.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

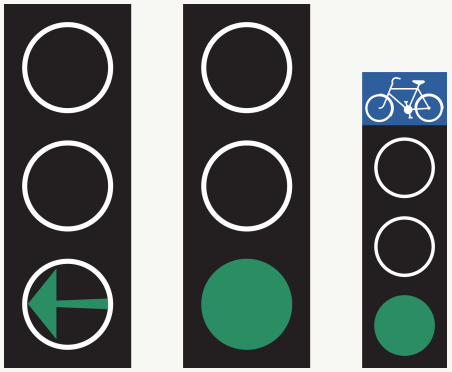


SIG2 · Red and amber vehicle signal

Röd + gul

Green is about to follow, but the stop instruction still applies. Do not start merely because amber has appeared. Red and amber illuminated together in arrow, full-lamp and bicycle examples.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



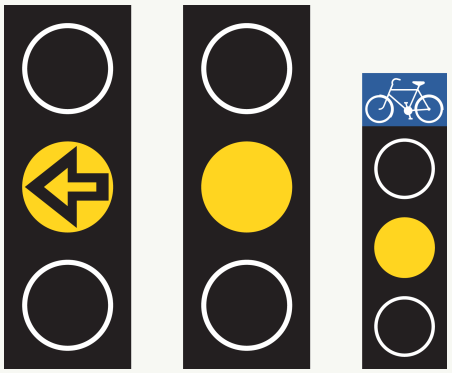
SIG3 · Green vehicle signal

Grön

You may proceed subject to the remaining traffic duties. A green arrow applies to its direction, including when another signal indication appears simultaneously. Green arrow, green full lamp and green bicycle signal examples.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning



SIG4 · Amber vehicle signal

Gul

Stop, unless the change from green occurs when stopping would be dangerous because you are already too close. An outline arrow limits the indication to its direction. Amber arrow, amber full lamp and amber bicycle signal examples.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Separate condition: flashing amber

SIG5 · Flashing amber vehicle signal

Blinkande gul

Proceed with particular caution and apply the other instructions and traffic rules. Flashing is not demonstrated by the still image. Amber flashing lamp represented by a still drawing.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

A red lane-control cross closes the lane; a green downward arrow allows its use; a diagonal amber arrow tells you to move in the indicated direction. Make any lane change safely. Signals for pedestrians or public transport are not automatically instructions for your car. Road Signs Regulation, chapter 3 §§7–15

Lane and public-transport signals

Lane-control signals and public-transport signals are separate sets. Follow the instruction that applies to your lane and traffic.

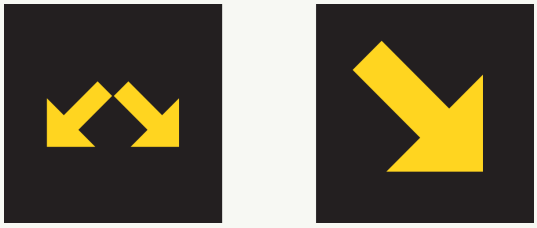
Lane control

SIG12 · Lane-control red cross

Rött kryss

The lane and, where applicable, its adjacent shoulder must not be used for traffic. Red cross on black.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



SIG13 · Lane-control amber arrow

Gul pil eller pilar

Change lane in an indicated direction, making the manoeuvre safely. Amber arrows point diagonally down to both sides in one example and down-right in another.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

SIG14 · Lane-control green arrow

Grön pil

The lane may be used. Other traffic restrictions and safety duties still apply. Green arrow points down.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Public transport

SIG8 · Public-transport signal — S

S

Stop before the line or, without one, before the signal. This is a signal for the traffic it controls, not a general car signal. White S in the upper lamp of a public-transport signal.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

SIG9 · Public-transport signal — S and horizontal bar

S+vågrätt streck

A proceed indication is about to follow, but the stop instruction remains in force. White S and horizontal bar lit together.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

SIG10 · Public-transport signal — vertical bar or arrow

Lodrätt streck eller pil

The controlled vehicle or tram may proceed. An arrow applies to its indicated direction. White vertical bar in the lower signal lamp.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

SIG11 · Public-transport signal — horizontal bar

Vågrätt streck

Stop unless the change from the vertical indication occurs so late that stopping would be dangerous. This is not the proceed indication. White horizontal bar in the middle signal lamp.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Markings. A broken centre or lane line identifies a boundary; it does not promise that overtaking is safe. A warning line indicates that crossing is unsuitable because of conditions and may precede a continuous line. Continuous lines and hatched areas have crossing restrictions, with specified exceptions such as a necessary passage around an obstruction under particular caution. A painted line is not an invitation to improvise an exception. Road Signs Regulation, chapter 4, M1/M3/M8/M9 · Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§9–11

Read the marking on your side

For paired lines, identify the line immediately beside your side of the road. The line on the far side does not grant you permission to cross.

M1 · Centre or lane line

Mittlinje eller körfältslinje

A broken line separates opposing directions or adjacent lanes, depending on its position. It does not guarantee that crossing or overtaking is safe. Two examples of a broken white line on a dark road background.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

M3 · Warning line

Varningslinje

Crossing this line is unsuitable because of the traffic conditions. It may also warn of a continuous line ahead. Long white strokes with short gaps.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

M8 · Continuous line

Heldragen linje

Crossing restrictions apply according to the type of continuous line and the traffic rules. Do not invent an exception merely because the road appears clear. Single and double continuous white lines.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

M9 · Hatched area

Spärrområde

Vehicles must not normally enter the marked area. Only the specified traffic-rule exceptions can justify crossing it. White hatched area on a dark road background.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

M10 · Broken line beside a continuous line

Mittlinje eller körfältslinje och heldragen linje

The continuous line governs a driver on its side of the marking. Do not treat the broken line on the other side as permission to change lanes. Broken white line beside a continuous line.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

M11 · Warning line beside a continuous line

Varningslinje och heldragen linje

The continuous-line side restricts lane changes; the warning-line side indicates that crossing is unsuitable. Warning line beside a continuous line.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

M12 · Centre line beside a warning line

Mittlinje och varningslinje

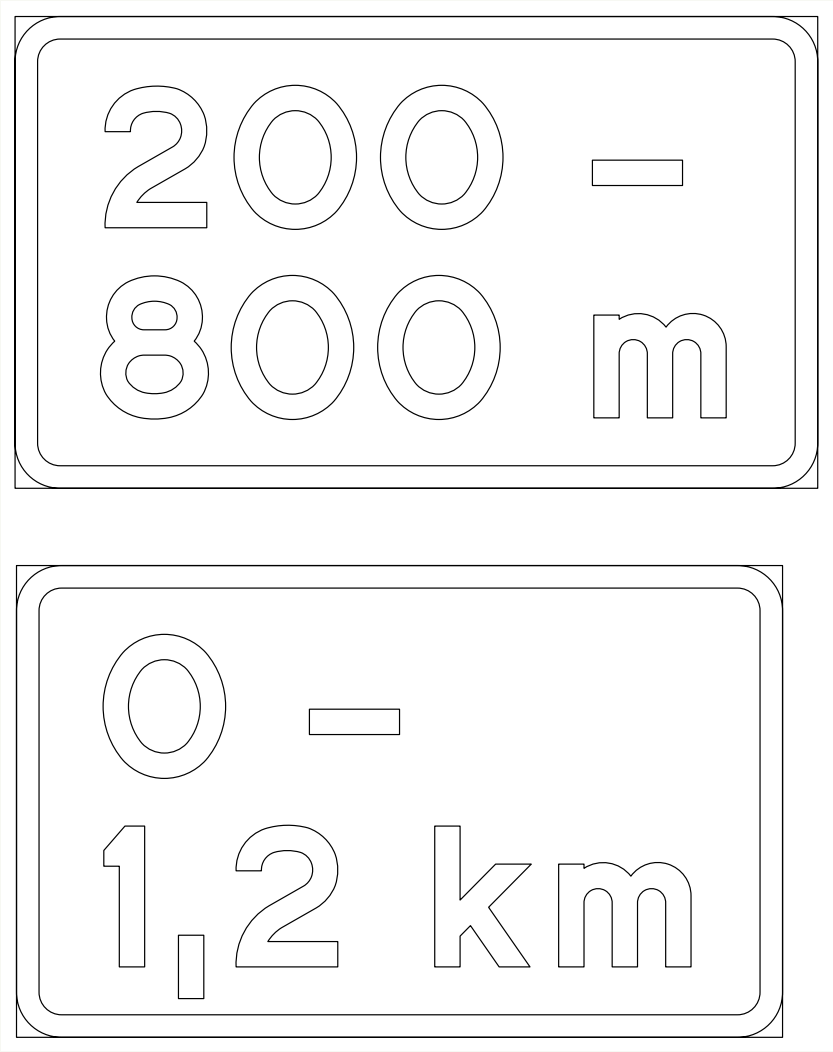
A driver on the warning-line side should recognise that crossing is unsuitable because of the conditions. Broken centre line beside a warning line.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Supplementary panels qualify the sign above them: read the distance, length, direction, time or vehicle symbol as part of the instruction. A distance **to** a hazard and the **length** of a hazardous stretch answer different questions. Supplementary panels

Read the supplementary panel

Independent recognition examples. A supplementary panel qualifies the sign above it on the road; these examples are not stacked into an invented instruction.



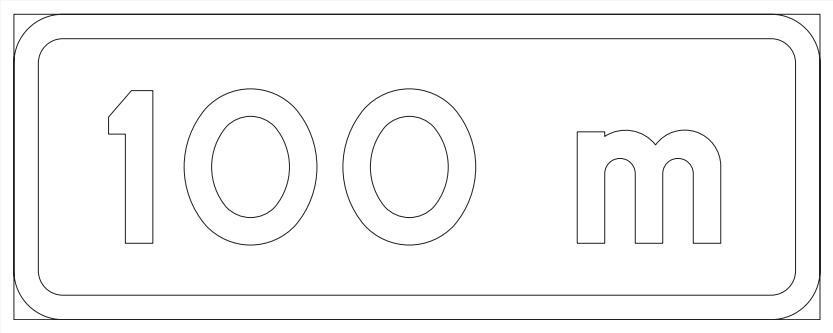
T1 · Length of affected road section

Vägsträckas längd

The panel identifies the beginning and end of the affected section. Distinguish this from a distance to a single feature.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning



T2 · Distance to the signed feature

Avstånd

This states how far ahead the main sign's subject lies, rather than the length of the affected section.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

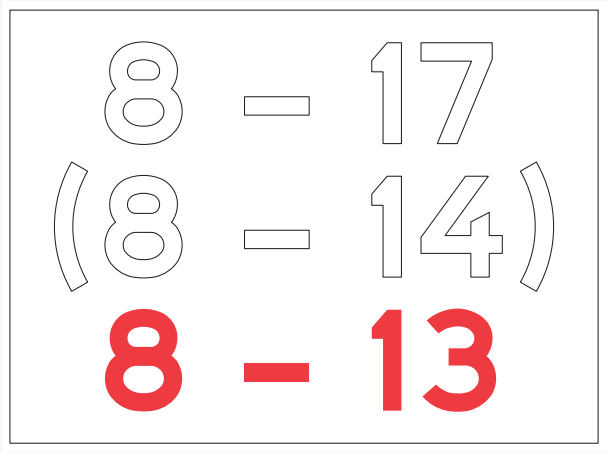
T3 · Distance to a stop requirement

Avstånd till stopplikt

Used below B1, this provides advance notice of a stop requirement at the indicated distance. It is not an instruction to stop at this advance sign. STOPP 200 m: a stop requirement 200 metres ahead.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

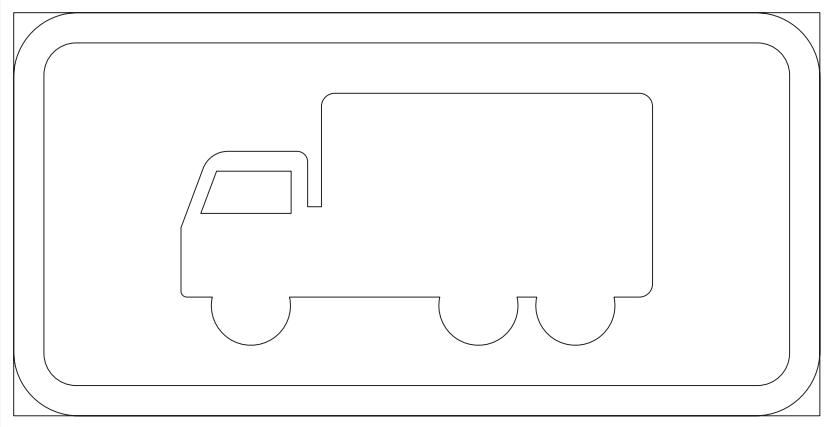


T6 · Time qualification

Tidsangivelse

Unbracketed black/white times apply on weekdays other than the day before a Sunday or public holiday; brackets mean those preceding days; red means Sundays and public holidays. A named day governs regardless of its category. A period crossing midnight continues into the next day.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



T8 · Vehicle or road-user qualification

Symboltavla

The sign above applies only to the vehicle or road-user group shown on the panel. Read time qualifications as part of the same instruction.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

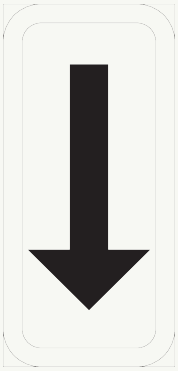
Continue the learning

T11 · Extent of the instruction

Utsträckning

Two-ended arrows indicate both sides of the sign; a downward arrow marks the end; a left or right arrow indicates that direction. Read the exact form and context. Black arrows point left and right.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

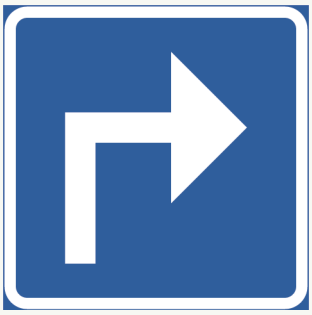


T11-2 · Extent of the instruction

Utsträckning

Two-ended arrows indicate both sides of the sign; a downward arrow marks the end; a left or right arrow indicates that direction. Read the exact form and context. Black arrow points down, marking the end of the instruction.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



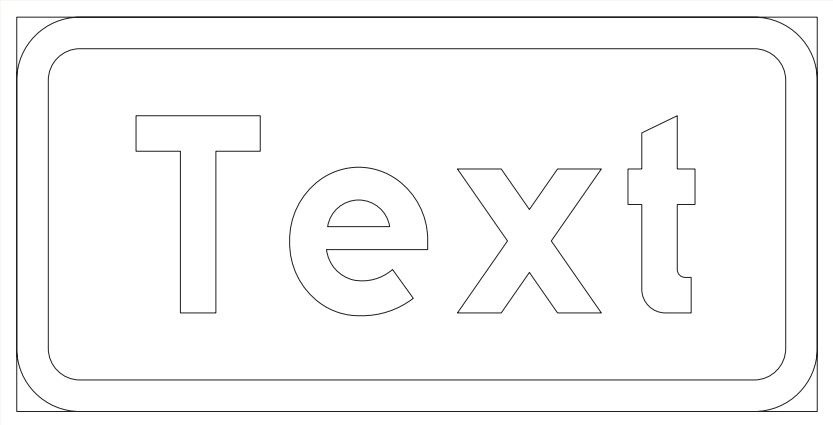
T12 · Direction to the signed feature

Riktning

Follow the indicated direction to the feature identified by the main sign. A right-turn arrow on blue.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

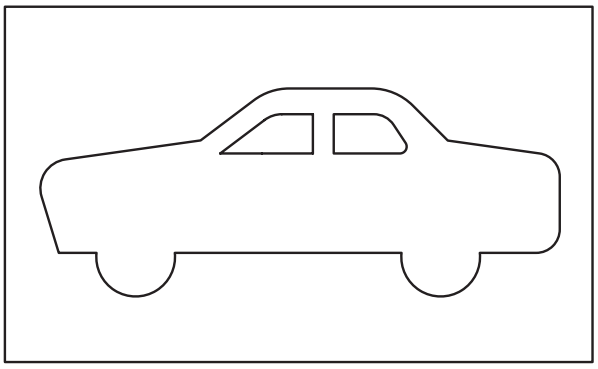


T22 · Additional written instruction

Text

Read the text as a qualification of the sign above; it supplies information not expressed by the other panels.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



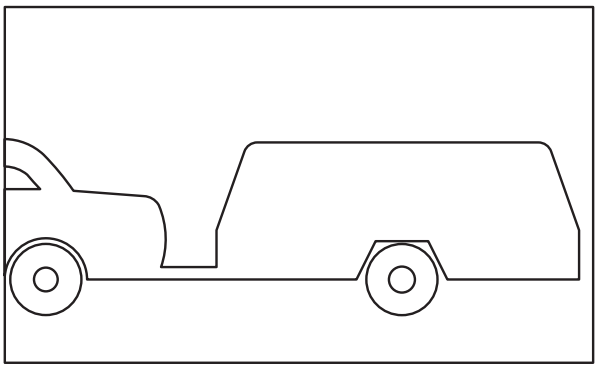
S3 · Passenger car symbol

Personbil

This symbol identifies passenger cars in the surrounding sign or panel.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

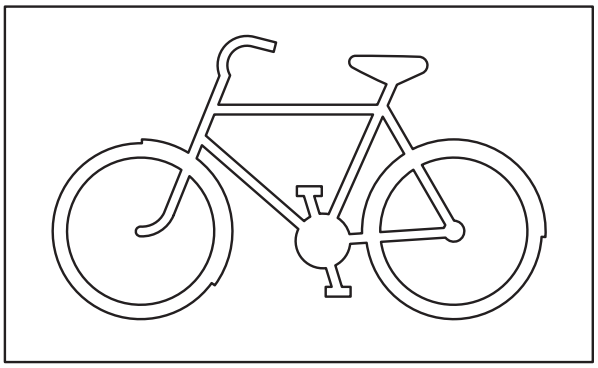


S4 · Passenger car with centre-axle trailer symbol

Personbil med tillkopplad släpkärra

This identifies a passenger car towing a släpkärra. Do not use it as a universal illustration of every trailer classification.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



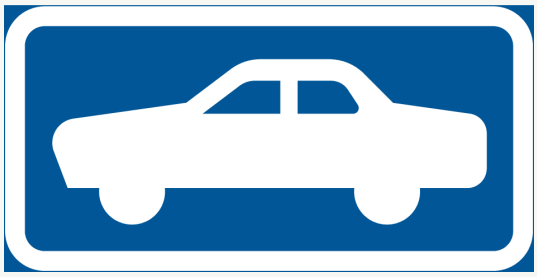
S8 · Bicycle and class II moped symbol

Cykel och moped klass II

This symbol identifies bicycles and class II mopeds, not class I mopeds.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

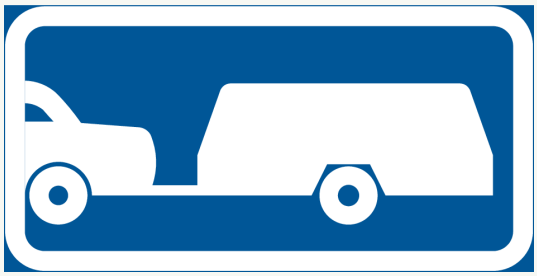


T8-3 · Vehicle or road-user qualification

Symboltavla

The sign above applies only to the vehicle or road-user group shown on the panel. Read time qualifications as part of the same instruction. Passenger car.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

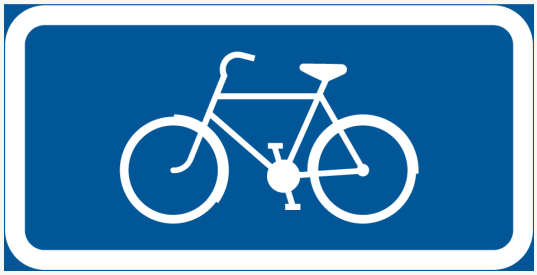


T8-4 · Vehicle or road-user qualification

Symboltavla

The sign above applies only to the vehicle or road-user group shown on the panel. Read time qualifications as part of the same instruction. Passenger car with centre-axle trailer.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



T8-8 · Vehicle or road-user qualification

Symboltavla

The sign above applies only to the vehicle or road-user group shown on the panel. Read time qualifications as part of the same instruction. Bicycle and class II moped.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Apply the learning

A green signal and a queue beyond the junction. Opposing traffic is separated and the stop line is before the crossing road. The scene is illustrative, not to scale.

Worked decision. Your signal is green, but a queue fills the space beyond the junction. Wait where you will not obstruct crossing traffic rather than entering a space you cannot clear. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §20

Knowledge check. Does amber mean accelerate to beat red?

Remember: Read the whole instruction and the space beyond it.

M03-L03

Find your way without rushing

Your goal: Use direction, facility and service signs to prepare route choices early.

Direction information appears before and at decision points. An advance direction sign helps you understand a junction or exit before reaching it; lane direction information helps you select a suitable lane. Direction signs for walking and cycling serve those modes and should not be mistaken for a car route. Facility, service and tourism signs help locate destinations; they do not cancel restrictions on access. Road Signs Regulation, chapter 2, F/G/H/I families

Advance directions and lane choice

Sample destinations are independent examples. They do not describe one continuous route.

F1-1 · Advance direction diagram

Orienteringstavla

Use this advance junction or roundabout diagram to plan your route before the decision point. Advance diagram: route 50 towards Falun ahead; Lindesberg to the right.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

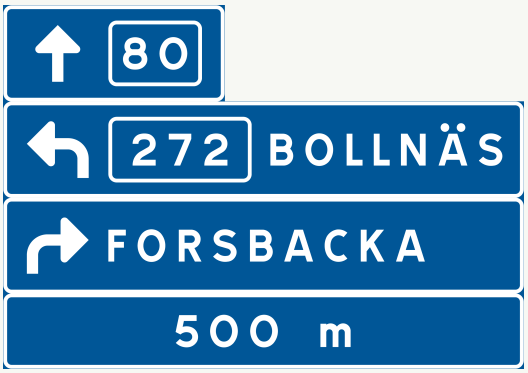
F1-2 · Advance direction diagram — alternative

Orienteringstavla

This is an alternative advance-direction layout. Read the destinations and the junction diagram before choosing your route. Roundabout advance diagram: Örebro ahead, Kumla left and Katrineholm right.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning



F3 · Advance destination table

Tabellorienteringstavla

Read the listed directions and approach distance before the junction or roundabout. Destination table: route 80 ahead; route 272 towards Bollnäs left; Forsbacka right; junction 500 m ahead.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F4 · Advance exit information

Avfartsorienteringstavla

An exit is ahead at the indicated distance. Prepare the appropriate lane safely. Advance exit towards Ornäs, 500 m ahead, while route 50 continues ahead.

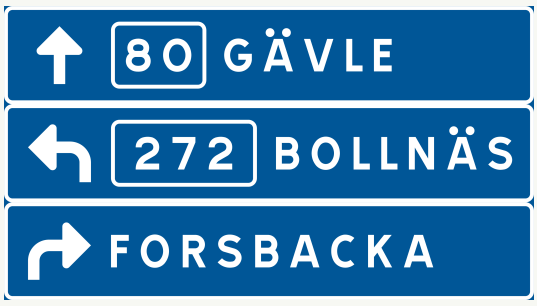
Transportstyrelsen · official description

F5 · Direction sign

Vägvisare

The sign points to a destination at a junction. Any stated distance is in whole kilometres. Right-pointing sign to Nyköping, 23 km.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



F6 · Destination table

Tabellvägvisare

This lists directions near a junction or roundabout, including at an exit from a roundabout. Destination table: Gävle via route 80 ahead, Bollnäs via route 272 left, Forsbacka right.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

F7 · Exit direction sign

Avfartsvisare

The exit begins at this sign. Do not make a late unsafe lane change to reach it. Exit sign pointing towards Mora via route 70 and towards Enköping.

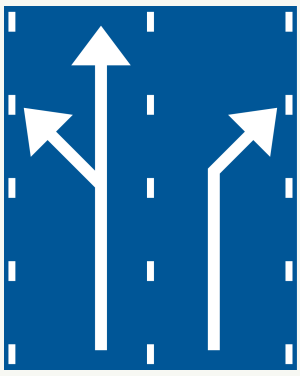
Transportstyrelsen · official description

F8 · Overhead lane destinations

Körfältsvägvisare

Use the lane or lanes beneath the relevant destination. Read any distance given for an upcoming exit. Overhead destinations: Boda on the left panel; Falun via route 50 on the right panel.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



F21 · Lane choices before a junction

Körfältsindelning före korsning

Choose a suitable lane for the direction you intend to take at the junction. Lane diagram before a junction, including left, ahead and right movements.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F27 · Interchange number

Trafikplatsnummer

This identifies the interchange number and may include an exit designation. Interchange number 75.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Walking and cycling routes

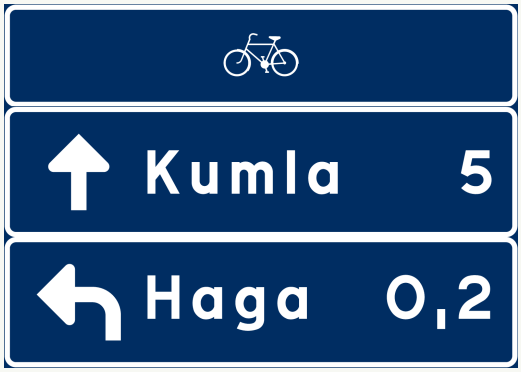
These walking and cycling examples are separate from car-route guidance. Standalone symbols retain their own official meaning.

F34 · Walking or cycling direction sign

Vägvisare

Read the road-user symbol and destination. A route for walking or cycling is not automatically a car route. Bicycle direction to Centrum, pointing right.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



F35 · Walking or cycling destination table

Tabellvägvisare

Directions and kilometre distances are given for the indicated road-user group. Bicycle destinations: Kumla 5 km ahead; Haga 0.2 km left.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F36 · Place name on a walking or cycling route

Platsmärke

This identifies a place for orientation along the route. Place name Lundby on a walking/cycling route sign.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

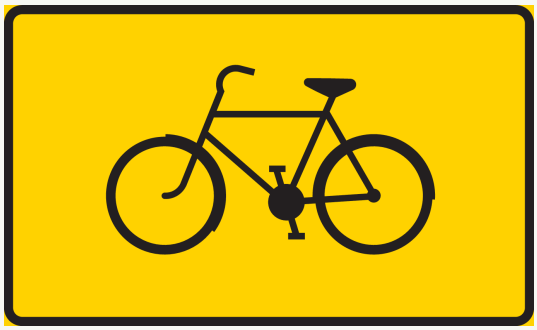
F37 · Walking or cycling distance board

Avståndstavla

Read the distances in kilometres together with the road-user symbol. Bicycle destination Centrum, 3 km.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

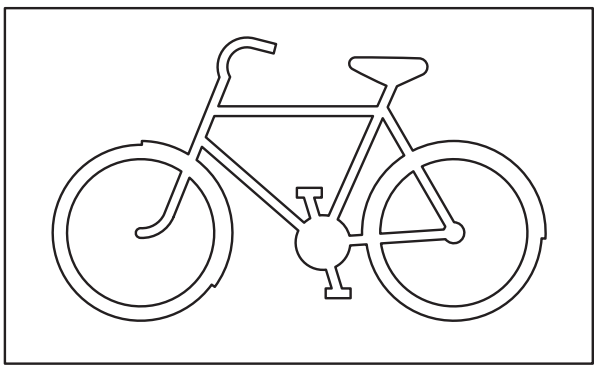


F38 · Cycle route

Cykelled

This identifies a specially designated cycle route; the colour scheme can vary. Bicycle pictogram identifying a cycle route.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



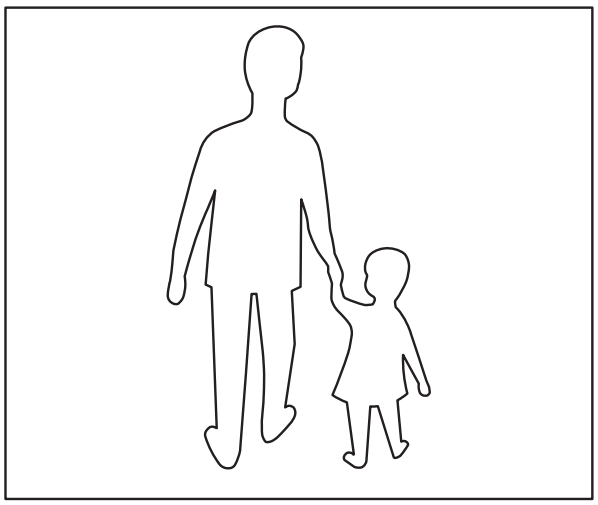
S8 · Bicycle and class II moped symbol

Cykel och moped klass II

This symbol identifies bicycles and class II mopeds, not class I mopeds.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning



S10 · Pedestrian symbol

Gående

This identifies pedestrians as the group covered by the surrounding instruction.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Learning approach. Know your next destination or route number, look for advance information and compare it with the road layout. Check the lane and movement required, then establish a safe opportunity to position the car. This is easier when navigation is prepared while parked and passengers understand that late instructions may be declined.

A symbol or route number may be easier to recognise than a place name. Learn the relevant symbols from the official catalogue rather than inventing an interpretation. Information signs can describe a changed route or other conditions; read enough of the message early to decide safely. Transportstyrelsen: sign catalogue

Destinations and route numbers

Compare route numbers and solid or dashed borders. The permanent alternative-route example is distinct from temporary orange guidance.

F9 · Grouped destinations

Samlingsmärke för vägvisning

The destinations inside the bracket share the route shown below its point. Pajala and Övertorneå grouped above the shared route via Kiruna.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F10 · Place name

Platsmärke

This identifies a place for orientation. It is not by itself a speed-limit sign. Place name Nyköping.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F11 · Road name

Vägnamn

This identifies the name of a road or route. Road name Hemvägen.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F13 · Distance board

Avståndstavla

Distances to the listed destinations are shown in whole kilometres. Distances: Stockholm 105 km; Södertälje 71 km.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

F14 · Road number

Vägnummer

This identifies a numbered route. A dashed border means the road leads towards the numbered route rather than necessarily being that route itself. E4 route shield with solid border.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F14-2 · Road number

Vägnummer

This identifies a numbered route. A dashed border means the road leads towards the numbered route rather than necessarily being that route itself. E4 route shield with dashed border, indicating a route towards E4.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F14-3 · Road number

Vägnummer

This identifies a numbered route. A dashed border means the road leads towards the numbered route rather than necessarily being that route itself. Route 58 shield with solid border.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

F14-4 · Road number

Vägnummer

This identifies a numbered route. A dashed border means the road leads towards the numbered route rather than necessarily being that route itself. Route 58 shield with dashed border, indicating a route towards route 58.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

F15 · Permanent diversion route

Omledning

This marks a permanent alternative route for the numbered road. Distinguish it from temporary orange diversion guidance. Permanent alternative route for road 58.

Transcriptstyrelsen · official description

J2 · Traffic information

Upplysningsmärke

Read the actual message: it supplies important information for safety or passage that is not given another way. Message: Vägsaltning upphör — road salting ends.

Transcriptstyrelsen · official description

Requirement. Destination signs can permit using the lane suited to your onward route, but changing into it still has to be safe. Do not cross a continuous lane boundary merely because you have chosen the wrong exit. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§7, 9 and 43

Apply the learning

Drivers approach a decision point in marked lanes. Plan the permitted route early. The illustration does not assign destinations to particular lanes.

Continue on the permitted route after a missed turn and find another safe opportunity. Not to scale.

Worked decision. A navigation instruction arrives after a driver has passed the safe lane-change opportunity. The driver continues in the permitted direction and finds another route. A missed turn is a planning problem; a sudden crossing of lanes creates a traffic problem.

Knowledge check. A service sign shows fuel at a junction. Does that guarantee that every approach or vehicle may enter the access road?

Facilities and services

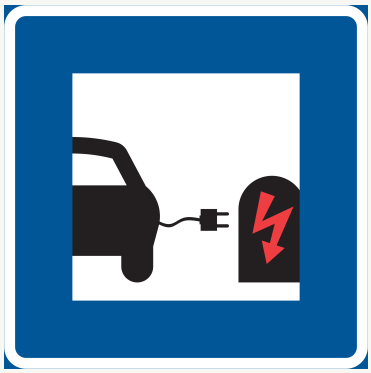
Separate reference examples for recognising facilities, services and tourist routes.

H3 · Fuel

Drivmedel

This identifies a fuel facility. It does not cancel access restrictions on the approach road. Fuel pump.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



H27 · Vehicle charging station

Laddstation

This identifies a facility for externally charging an electrically powered vehicle. Car connected to a charging unit.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

G4 · Hospital with an emergency department

Akutsjukhus

This points to a hospital with an emergency department, not simply any medical facility. Red cross on white within a blue sign.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

H1 · Information point

Informationsplats

Information is available at the indicated place. Nearby text may identify the type of information. Lower-case information letter i.

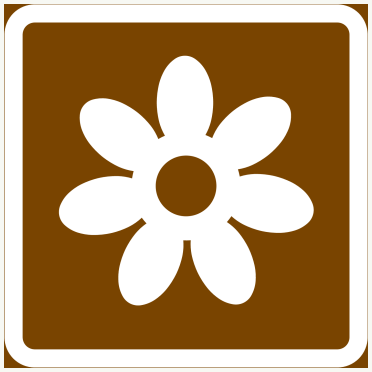
Transportstyrelsen · official description

H13 · Rest area

Rastplats

This identifies a rest area with a toilet accessible to people with mobility impairments. Picnic table and tree.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



I1 · Tourist route

Turistväg

The road or route has tourist interest. Ordinary traffic restrictions still apply. White flower on brown.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Remember: A route can be corrected later. An unsafe last-second manoeuvre cannot be planned away afterwards.

M03-L04

Leave room to respond

Your goal: Explain how observation, speed, reaction, braking, grip and following space affect your options.

Requirements. Choose a speed that preserves control and lets you stop within the road you can see and before a foreseeable obstruction. Your distance from the vehicle ahead must allow for it slowing or stopping. Weather, visibility, road condition, vehicle condition and loading all matter. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§2 and 14–16

For an ordinary car, the general speed limits are 50 km/h within a built-up area and 70 km/h outside it, unless another applicable limit has been prescribed. The motorway default is 110 km/h; 120 km/h can be prescribed. Local and road-specific limits often differ, and a lower vehicle-combination limit still applies. Read the current signs and conditions rather than selecting a speed from the road's appearance. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §17, chapter 4 §20 and chapter 9 §1

Limits and road regimes

Numeric maximum-speed examples are independent. Start and end types are labelled individually; unequal values do not form a sequence.

C31 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 30: maximum 30 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

C31-4 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 40: maximum 40 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C31-5 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 50: maximum 50 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C31-7 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 70: maximum 70 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

C31-8 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 80: maximum 80 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C31-11 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 110: maximum 110 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

C31-12 · Maximum speed

Hastighetsbegränsning

Do not exceed the displayed speed in km/h. A junction alone does not necessarily end the limit, and conditions may require a lower speed. Red-bordered yellow circle displaying 120: maximum 120 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

C32 · End of temporary speed limit

Tillfällig hastighetsbegränsning upphör

The temporary signed speed limit ends. Establish the speed limit that now applies rather than assuming there is none. 30 crossed by diagonal black lines: temporary 30 km/h limit ends.

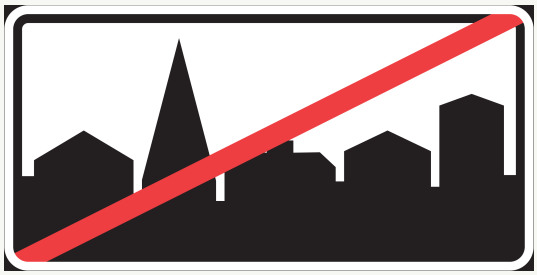
Transportstyrelsen · official description

E5 · Built-up area

Tättbebyggt område

A built-up area begins. Establish the applicable speed limit and other rules; a separate sign may prescribe a different limit. Black settlement skyline on white.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



E6 · End of built-up area

Tättbebyggt område upphör

The built-up area ends. Check the rules and signed limits for the road ahead. Settlement skyline crossed by a red diagonal.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

E11 · Recommended lower speed

Rekommenderad lägre hastighet

The sign recommends a lower speed because of the road's conditions or measures. Distinguish it from a C31 legal maximum. Blue sign reading max 30 km/tim: recommended 30 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning

E12 · End of recommended lower speed

Rekommenderad lägre hastighet upphör

The signed recommendation ends. Continue to choose a speed suited to conditions and legal limits. Blue max 30 km/tim sign crossed by a red diagonal.

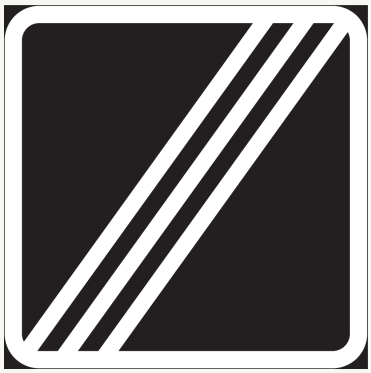
Transportstyrelsen · official description

E13 · Recommended maximum speed

Rekommenderad högsta hastighet

This variable sign recommends a temporary lower maximum because of current conditions. The recommendation is below the legal maximum. White 50 on a dark variable-sign background: recommended maximum 50 km/h.

Transportstyrelsen · official description



E14 · End of recommended maximum speed

Rekommenderad högsta hastighet upphör

The temporary speed recommendation ends. White diagonal lines on a dark background.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Think of stopping in two parts. During the time between noticing a hazard and beginning effective braking, the vehicle still travels. After that, it travels while slowing. More speed consumes more distance during the same delay and increases the energy that must be removed. Less available friction reduces what the tyres can do for braking and steering. Trafikverket: speed and impact · VTI friction report, sections 4.2–4.3

Continue the learning

Illustrative calculation, not a stopping-distance prediction. A speed of 50 km/h is approximately 13.9 metres per second: 50 ÷ 3.6. If a hypothetical response delay is one second, that is about 14 metres before braking begins. At 80 km/h the same assumed delay consumes about 22 metres. These figures are unit conversions using an assumed delay; people do not all react in one second, and braking distance has not yet been added.

Learning approach. Scan far enough ahead to see developing situations, while revisiting the near area, mirrors and places where someone may enter. Avoid staring at one hazard until everything else disappears from attention. Increase your margin when information is poor. A timed following-gap check can help you notice a short gap, but no fixed number is safe in every condition.

Safety advice · Check a timed gap. For the three-second following-distance guideline, select a fixed roadside point, such as a pole or sign. When the rear of the vehicle ahead passes it, start counting at a steady seconds pace. Stop when the front of your car reaches the same point. Arriving before three seconds indicates a short gap against that guideline: ease back smoothly and check again. Three seconds is a guideline, not a statutory fixed interval or a guarantee; poor grip, visibility or other hazards require more space and an appropriate speed. Keep observing the road while counting. NSW Government: fixed-point following-gap method

Fixed-point example. The car ahead passes a sign. You count “one thousand and one, one thousand and two, one thousand and three”. If your car reaches the sign while you are still on “two”, increase the gap smoothly. At a hypothetical constant 60 km/h, three seconds represents 60 ÷ 3.6 × 3 = 50 metres. A timed gap therefore represents more metres at higher speed, without requiring you to estimate metres by eye.

Margins and braking distance

Safety advice · When someone follows too closely. Increase your gap to the vehicle ahead gradually, allowing you to ease off and brake more gently if traffic slows. This gives the following driver more time to respond. Do not brake sharply to warn or punish them, or accelerate into an unsafe speed. If an emergency requires braking, brake as necessary; this advice does not mean withholding it. Northern Ireland government: tailgater response

Tailgater example. Maya has a close follower and sees brake lights farther ahead. She eases off early to create room in front and slows progressively. She cannot control the follower, but she can reduce the need for a sudden stop.

Physical explanation · Twice the speed. With the same effective grip and braking deceleration on the same gradient, braking distance is approximately proportional to speed squared: **2 × speed → 4 × braking distance**. In a constant-deceleration model, distance = speed² ÷ (2 × deceleration), with speed in metres per second. Doubling speed multiplies the numerator by four. Real conditions and brake response can change; this is a comparison under stated assumptions. Trafikverket: VGU braking-distance equation

Hypothetical comparison. Assume a level road, unchanged vehicle/load/grip, constant braking deceleration of 5 m/s² and a one-second response delay. At 40 km/h, braking distance is about 12.3 m and reaction distance 11.1 m. At 80 km/h they are 49.4 m and 22.2 m: braking quadruples while reaction distance doubles. Total stopping distances are about 23.5 m and 71.6 m, so the total does **not** quadruple. These invented model conditions explain the relationship; they are not predicted stopping distances for your car.

Apply the learning

A driver approaches a queue on a divided road. The illustrated gap is not a measured safe following distance. Look ahead and leave room to respond.

Worked decision. You can see over the roof of the car ahead that traffic is slowing. Ease your approach early rather than waiting for its brake lights at a short distance. The benefit is having choices before braking becomes urgent.

Knowledge check. (1) If response delay doubles at the same speed, what happens to reaction distance? (2) How do you time a three-second following gap? (3) Why increase the forward gap when someone follows too closely? (4) With unchanged braking deceleration, how does doubled speed affect braking distance, and does total stopping distance also quadruple?

Remember: Space is useful because it gives you time to notice, decide and act.

Review and self-assessment

A route decision on an unfamiliar road. Use the written scenario and the linked official examples; these separate illustrations do not form one verified junction.

A junction approach with a changing traffic situation. Describe your decision before reading the review guide. Not to scale.

Scenario: You approach an unfamiliar junction with an advance direction sign, a supplementary panel, a changing signal and a queue beyond it.

Explain which information determines your route, which creates a duty, and where you would wait.

Use these earlier independent examples as references:

F1-1 · Advance direction diagram

SIG3 · Green vehicle signal

T11 · Extent of the instruction

Keep a practice record

Identify one type of information you noticed late. Explain the consequence and choose a reference or supervised observation exercise to improve it. Syllabus self-assessment, chapters 2–3 §3

Review after answering

M03-L01

Answer: No. Assess the hazard, visibility, road surface and people present as well as the applicable limit.

M03-L02

Answer: No. The rule is to stop; the exception concerns an unsafe stop after the change, not a wish to save time.

M03-L03

Answer: No. Follow the access signs and restrictions as well as the destination information.

M03-L04

Answer: (1) It doubles under the constant-speed assumption. (2) Count seconds from the rear of the car ahead passing a fixed point until your front reaches that point; three seconds is a guideline and conditions may require more. (3) More forward space allows gentler slowing and gives the follower more time; avoid unnecessary sudden braking. (4) Braking distance becomes approximately four times as long, but reaction distance doubles for the same response delay, so the combined total does not generally quadruple.

M03-R

Review guide: Select the relevant lane early, obey the applicable signal and panel, and keep the junction clear. A destination preference does not override a restriction.

Official references

Original references checked 4 October 2026; G3 additions checked 12 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Transportstyrelsen: sign catalogue

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/trafikregler-och-vagmarken/vagmarken/

Road Signs Regulation, chapter 2

https://www.riksdagen.se/sv/dokument-och-lagar/dokument/svensk-forfattningssamling/vagmarkesforordning-200790_sfs-2007-90/

Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§14–15

https://www.riksdagen.se/sv/dokument-och-lagar/dokument/svensk-forfattningssamling/trafikforordning-19981276_sfs-1998-1276/

Supplementary panels

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/trafikregler-och-vagmarken/vagmarken/tillaggstavlor/

Official references

Original references checked 4 October 2026; G3 additions checked 12 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Trafikverket: speed and impact

https://www.trafikverket.se/resa-och-trafik/trafiksakerhet/sakerhet-pa-vag/hastighetsgranser-pa-vag/hastighet-och-krockvald/

VTI friction report, sections 4.2–4.3

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/globalassets/global/regler/jarnvag/plan-och-byggregler-for-vagar-och-sparbunden-trafik/vti-rapport-friktionsegenskaper.pdf

NSW Government: fixed-point following-gap method

https://www.nsw.gov.au/driving-boating-and-transport/driving-nsw/roads-safety-and-rules/safe-driving/safe-stopping-distance

Northern Ireland government: tailgater response

https://www.northernireland.gov.uk/sites/default/files/2025-08/taxi-manual-august-2025.pdf

Road-sign illustrations: Transportstyrelsen. Each example links to its official description. Swedish names are official; English labels and explanations are editorial translations.

Some outline examples are exact vector extracts from the official Swedish road-sign poster. They are retained at their reviewed size.

Transportstyrelsen · Sveriges vägmärken (official poster)

Official references

Original references checked 4 October 2026; G3 additions checked 12 October 2026. Sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Consult current guidance and applicable rules.

Trafikverket: VGU braking-distance equation

https://trafikverket.diva-portal.org/smash/get/diva2%3A1909331/FULLTEXT01.pdf

Syllabus self-assessment, chapters 2–3 §3

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/TSFS/TSFS%202011_20.pdf